

Microsoft Interview Handbook

1. Company Overview

Microsoft is a leader in software, services, and cloud (Azure). Its culture emphasizes a “Growth Mindset” and collaboration.

2. Hiring Process (2025-2026)

- **Recruiter Screen:** 30-45 mins.
- **Technical Screen:** 45-60 mins (Teams/CoderPad).
- **Onsite Loop:** 4-5 rounds (60 mins each):
 - **Coding Rounds (3):** DSA and problem-solving.
 - **System Design (1):** Scalability and architecture (SDE II+).
 - **Behavioral (1):** Growth mindset and cultural fit.
- **AA Round (As Appropriate):** Final interview with a senior leader.

3. Data Structures & Algorithms (DSA)

Frequently Asked Problems

Topic	Problem Example	Difficulty
Linked Lists	Reverse a Linked List, Merge K Sorted Lists	Medium
Trees	Binary Tree Level Order Traversal, Symmetric Tree	Medium
Strings	Reverse Words in a Sentence, Valid Palindrome	Easy/Medium
Arrays	Missing Number, Two Sum	Easy/Medium

4. Machine Learning & AI

- **Azure AI:** Knowledge of Azure Machine Learning and Cognitive Services.
- **Copilot/GenAI:** Questions on integrating AI into developer workflows.

- **ML Design:** Designing an autocomplete system or a news feed.

5. System Design

- **Key Concepts:** CAP Theorem, SQL vs NoSQL, Load Balancing, Microservices.
- **Common Questions:** Design a Messenger System (like Teams), Design a Distributed Database, Design a URL Shortener.

6. Behavioral Questions

- “Why Microsoft?”
- “Tell me about a time you failed and what you learned.”
- “Describe a situation where you had to work with a difficult colleague.”
- “What is your favorite Microsoft product and how would you improve it?”

7. Online Assessment (OA)

- **Platform:** Codility.
- **Format:** 3 coding problems in 60-90 minutes.
- **Focus:** Accuracy and efficiency.

8. Preparation Tips

- Master fundamental CS concepts (OS, Networking, DBMS).
- Practice coding on a collaborative editor without syntax highlighting.
- Be prepared for “As Appropriate” (AA) round questions on long-term vision.

9. References

- [Microsoft Careers - Technical Interviewing](#)
- [I Got An Offer - Microsoft Interview Questions](#)
- [GetSDEReady - Top Microsoft Interview Questions 2025](#)